

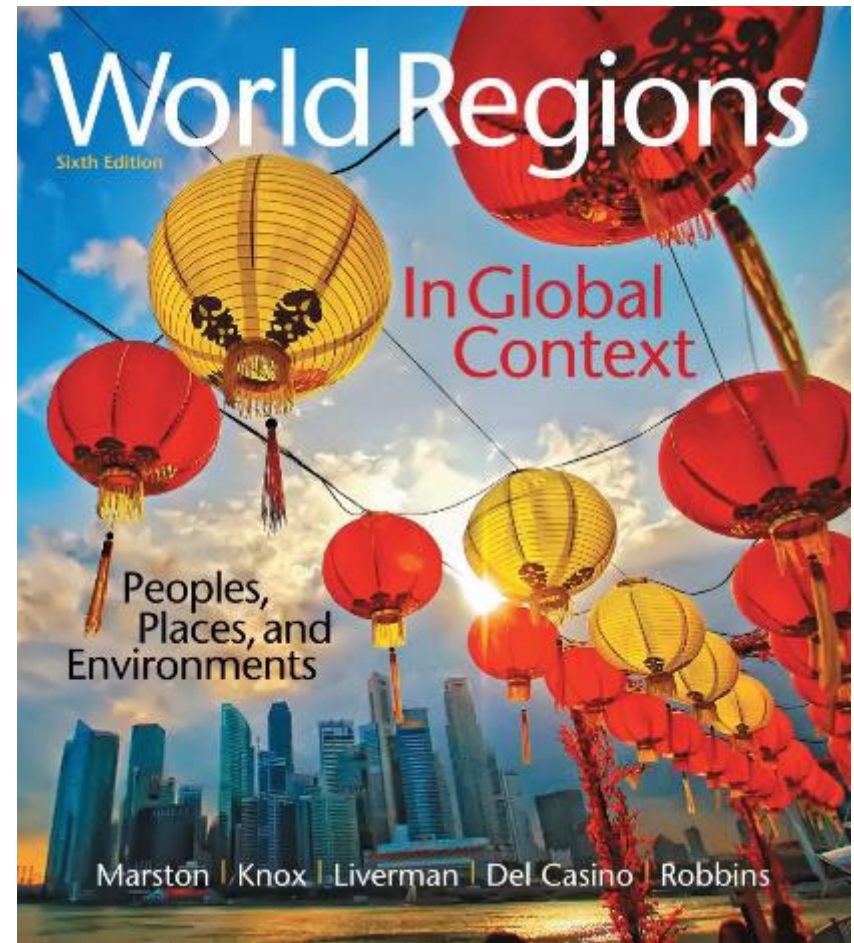
# Chapter 4 Lecture

## World Regions in Global Context: Peoples, Places, and Environments

6<sup>th</sup> Edition

### Middle East and North Africa

**Lectures by:**  
Christa Ann Smith



# Learning Outcomes

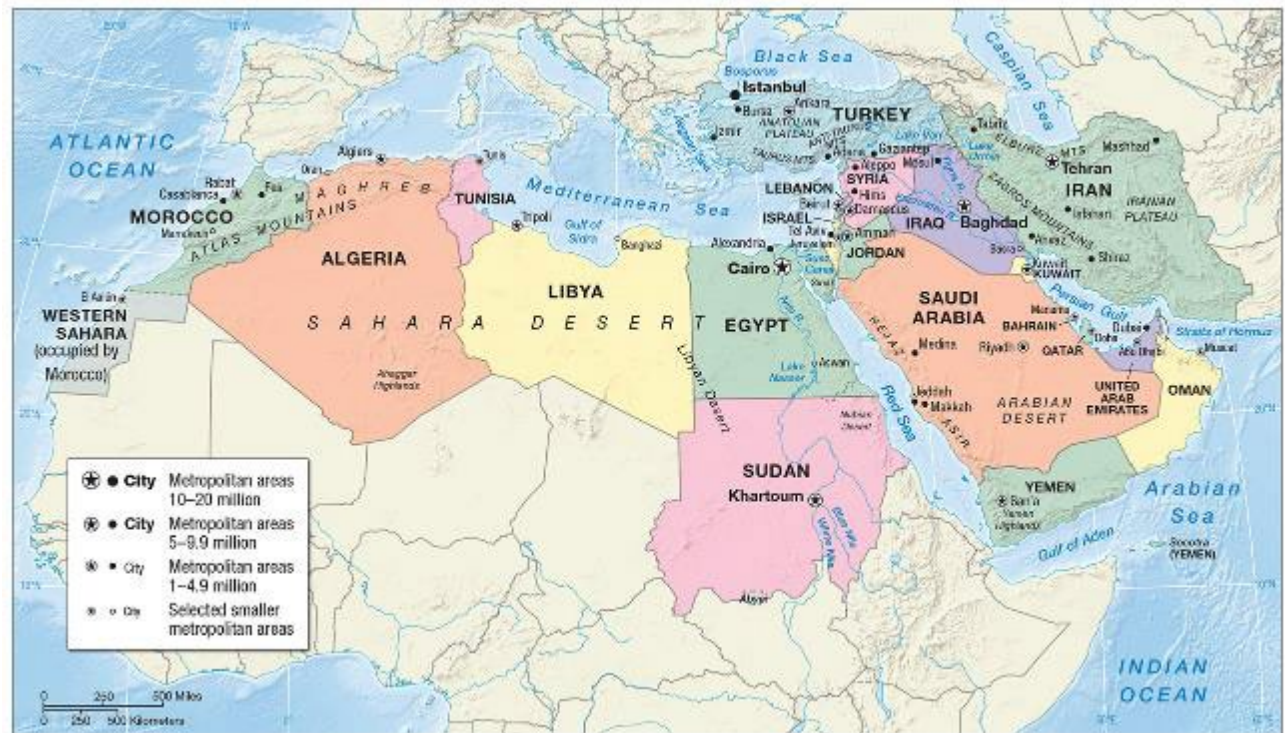
- Describe the diversity of physical geographic environments in the Middle East and North Africa.
- Evaluate the importance of key resources, such as oil and water.
- Summarize the diffusion of cultural and environmental practices, such as religion and agriculture, throughout the region.
- Explain the natural and historical factors that contribute to the diverse economies of the Middle East and North Africa, how they vary from country to country, and how they are tied to global and regional processes.

# Learning Outcomes

- Analyze the geopolitical conflicts and tensions that bring instability to the Middle East and North Africa and the relationship between these conflicts and the political history of the region.
- Identify the differences in practices of kinship, gender, and religion in the region and how these factors affect the lives of women.
- Describe the patterns of migration in the Middle East and North Africa, the push and pull factors that are involved in migration patterns, and the effects these patterns have on the region's demography.

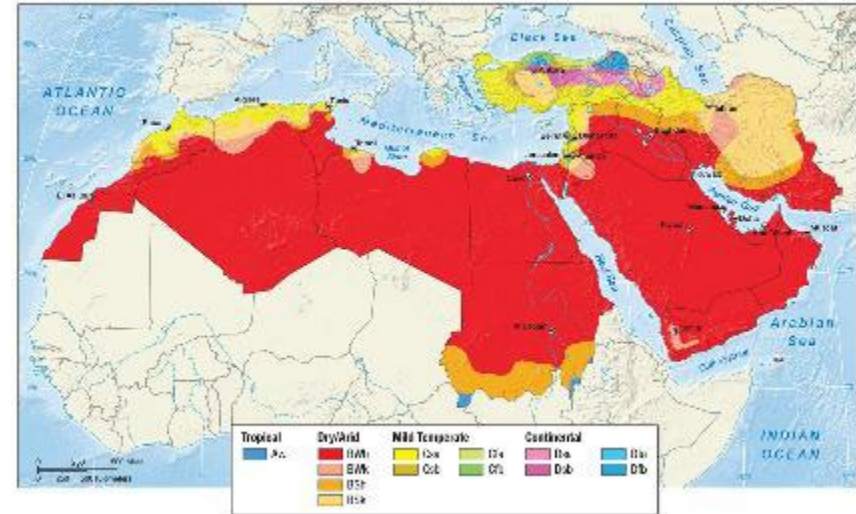
# Environment, Society, and Sustainability

- Environmentally diverse
- Home of some of the earliest agricultural societies in the world
- Historically significant rivers



# Climate and Climate Change

- Dominant climate characteristic is **aridity**
  - three-quarters of the region receive less than 10 inches of rain annually
- Highland and coastal areas more moderate
  - thin, deficient soils
- Mountains
  - orographic rainfall
  - **rain shadow**



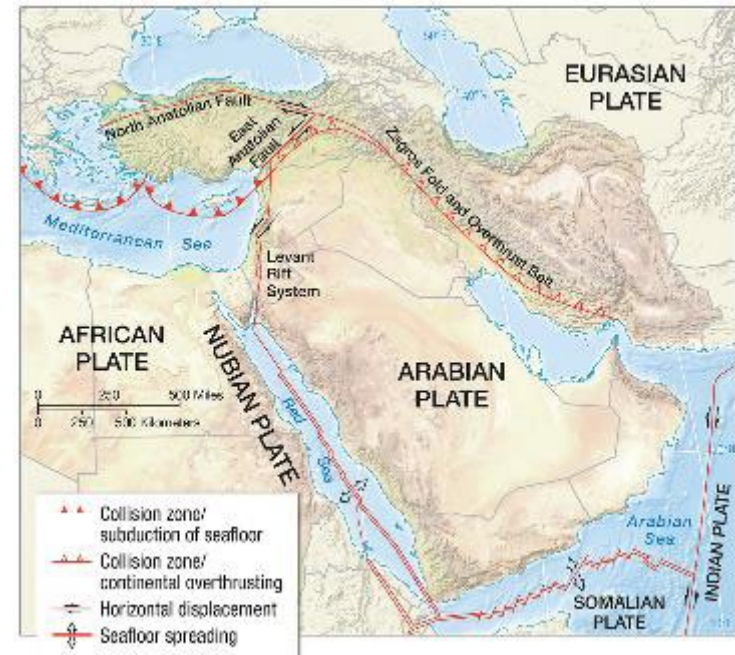
# Climate and Climate Change (cont.)

- Climatic adaptation
  - regional architecture
  - activity patterns
  - dress
- Climate change
  - Kyoto Protocol
  - **carbon market**



# Geological Resources, Risk, and Water

- Region home to multiple mountain ranges, two major river systems



# Geological Resources, Risk, and Water (cont.)

- Mountain and coastal environments
  - African, Eurasian, and Arabian plates
  - earthquake hazard
  - Turkey, Iran, Yemen, Morocco



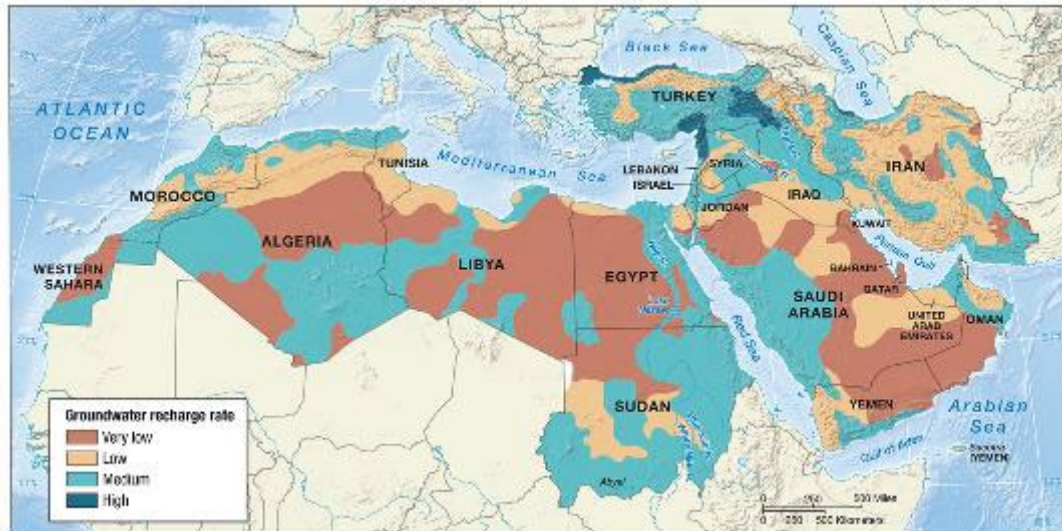
(a)



(b)

# Geological Resources, Risk, and Water (cont.)

- Regions most precious commodity: water
  - Nile, Tigris, and Euphrates Rivers
  - **Oases**
  - **gravity system**
    - *Qanat, flaj, foggara*
  - **desalinization**



# Geological Resources, Risk, and Water (cont.)

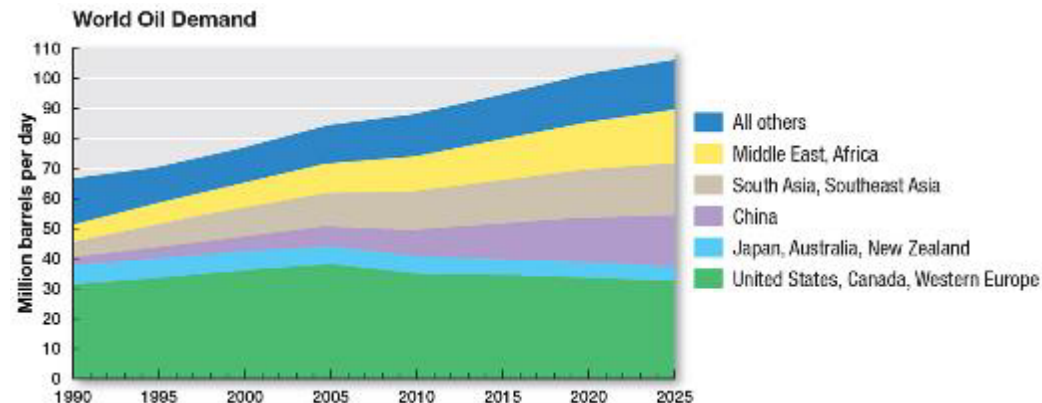
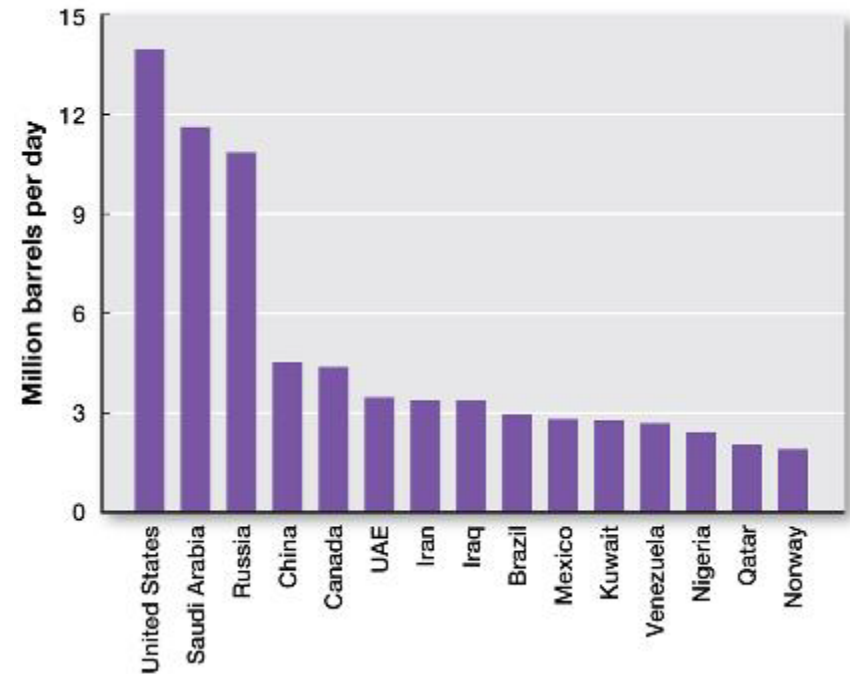
- **Fossil Fuels**

- oil and natural gas
- **petroleum**
- invention of internal combustion engine and WW I established petroleum as a foundational product of industrial age
- early areas: Iran, 1900; Iraq 1920s; Bahrain, Saudi Arabia, 1930s

- **Organization of Oil Exporting Countries (OPEC)**

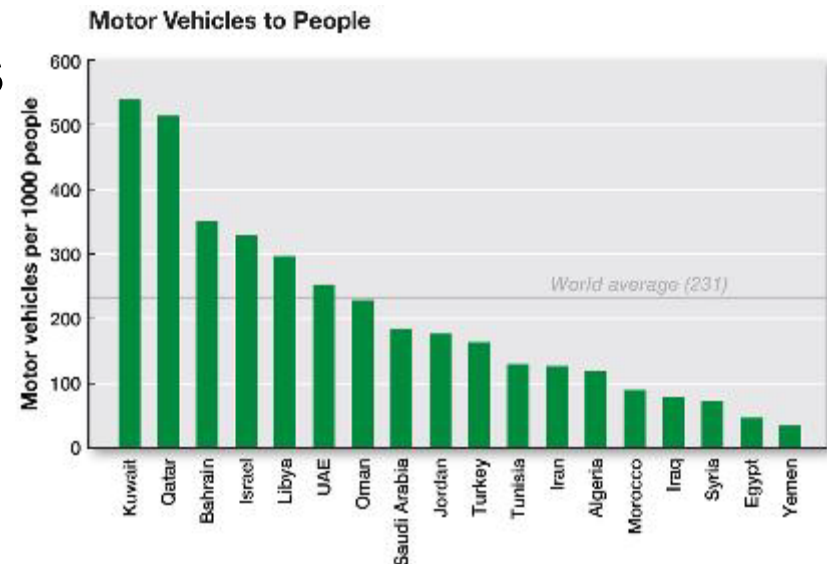
- oil crisis

Petroleum Production 2014



# Geographies of Indulgence, Desire, and Addiction

- Luxury cars, such as Bentley, saw rise in sales driven by high demand in Middle East
- Dubai has highest ratio of cars to people in the world
- Region home to many high-end Formula One races



# Ecology, Land, and Environmental Management

- Deforestation in Turkey, Lebanon, Syria, and Iran
- Extinctions
  - leopards
  - crocodiles
  - oryx
  - cheetahs
  - lions
- **Desertification**
- **Afforestation**



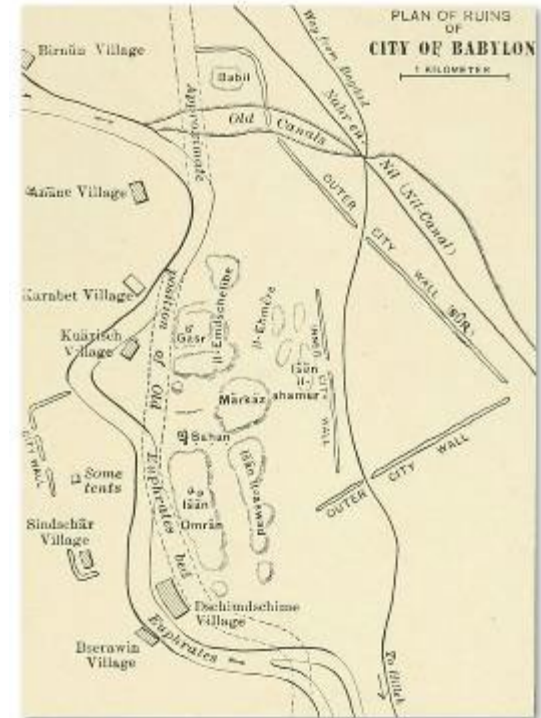
# History, Economy, and Territory

- Domestication of plants and animals
  - 10,000 to 12,000 years ago
  - semi-permanent settlements



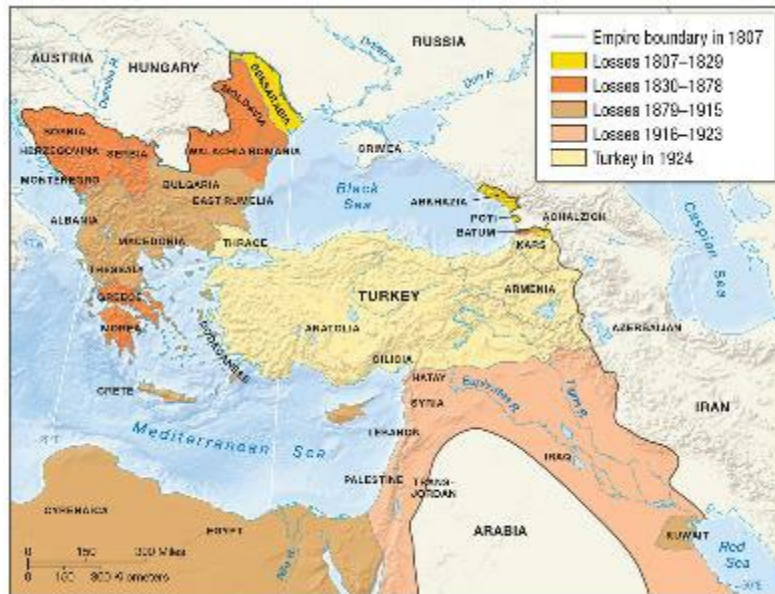
# Historical Legacies and Landscapes

- **Fertile Crescent:** early plant and animal domestication
  - wet farming
  - hydraulic civilizations
- Birthplace of **world religions:** Judaism, Christianity, and Islam
- Urbanization
  - primary urbanization
  - secondary urbanization
  - Islamic cities



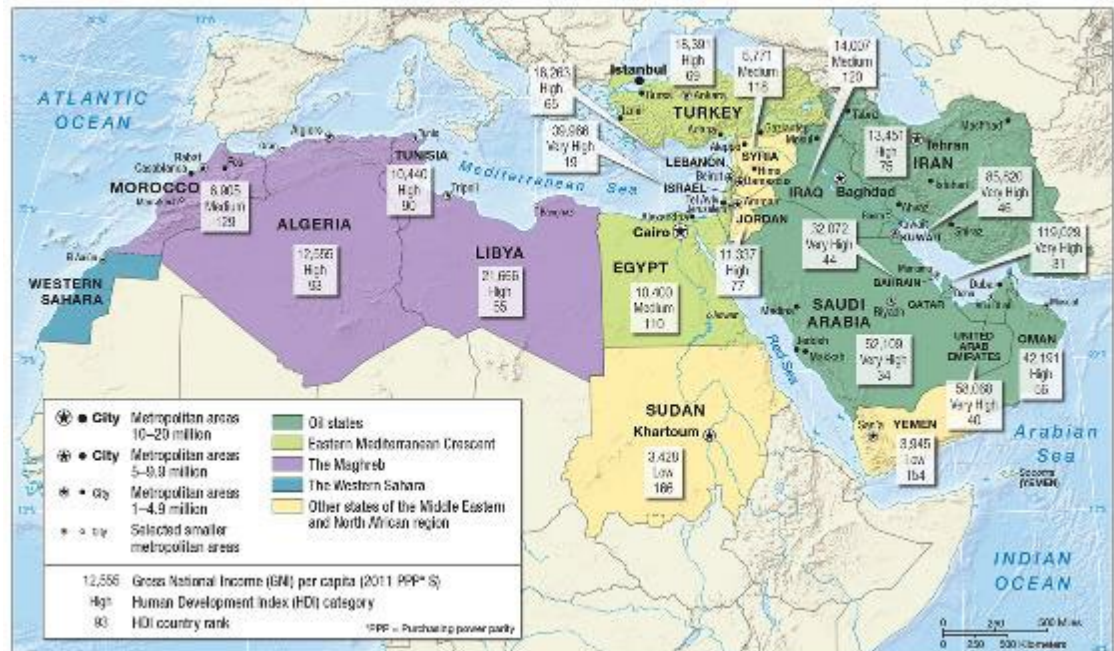
# Historical Legacies and Landscapes (cont.)

- Ottoman Empire
  - nationalist movements
  - mandates
- “Middle East”: What’s in a name?



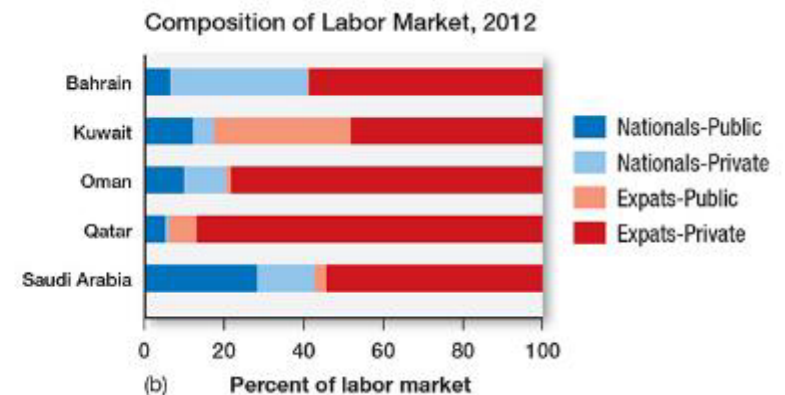
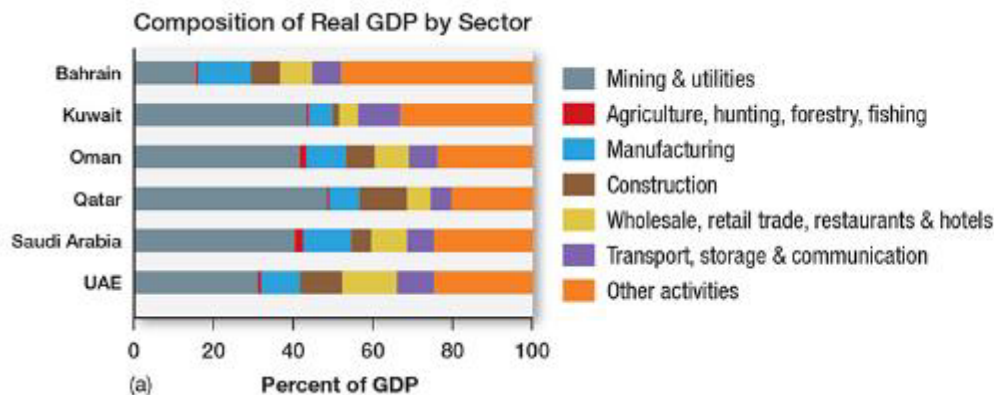
# Economy, Accumulation, and the Production of Inequality

- Import substitution
- **Nationalization**
- Rural-to-urban migration
  - informal economy
- Oil states
  - oil dependence
  - **petrodollars**
  - economic diversification



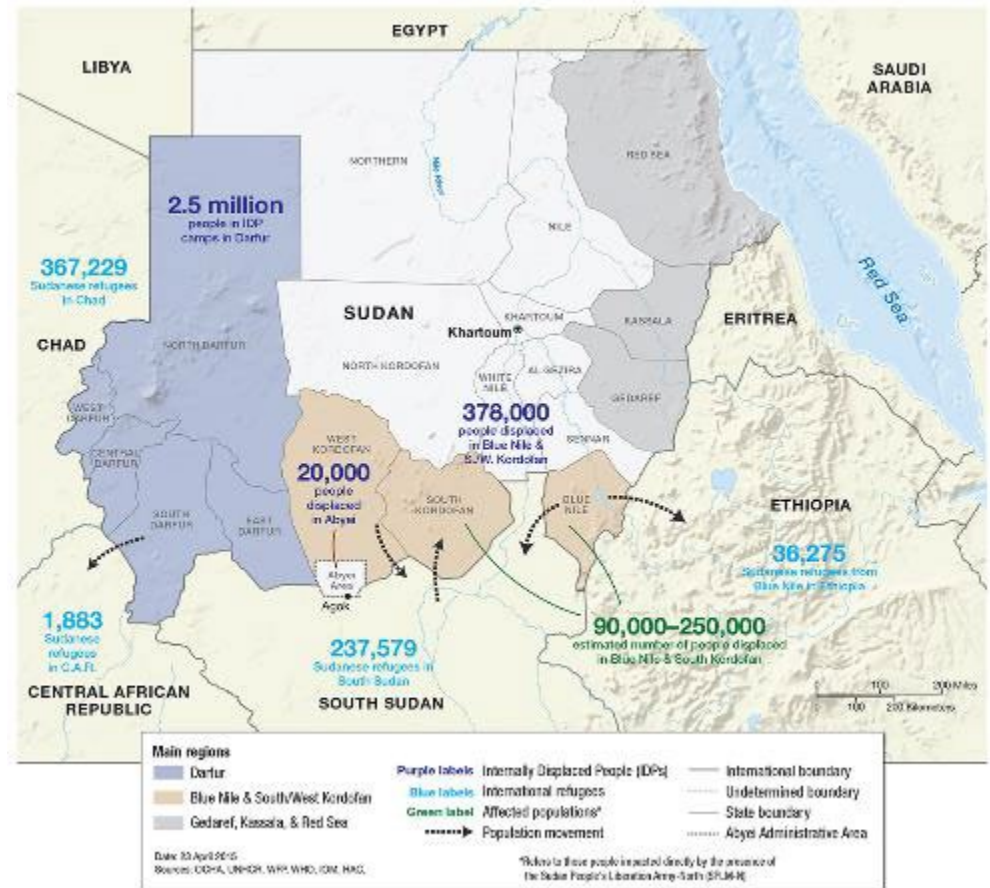
# Economy, Accumulation, and the Production of Inequality (cont.)

- Eastern Mediterranean Crescent
  - Egypt, Lebanon, Israel, Turkey
- The Maghreb
  - Morocco, Algeria, Tunisia, Libya
  - **Union for the Mediterranean**
- Social inequalities



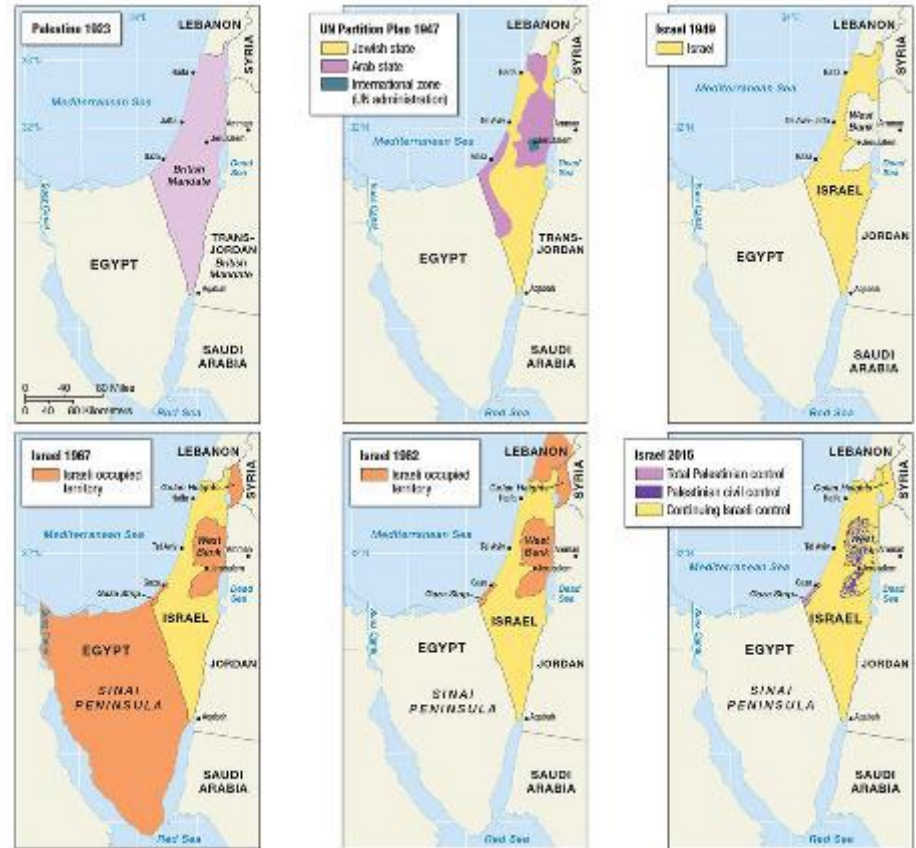
# Territory and Politics

- Intra-regional conflict
- Ethnic conflict
  - Iran (Persians) and Iraq (Arabs)
  - **Kurds**
  - Sudan
  - **Janjaweed**
  - **internally displaced persons**



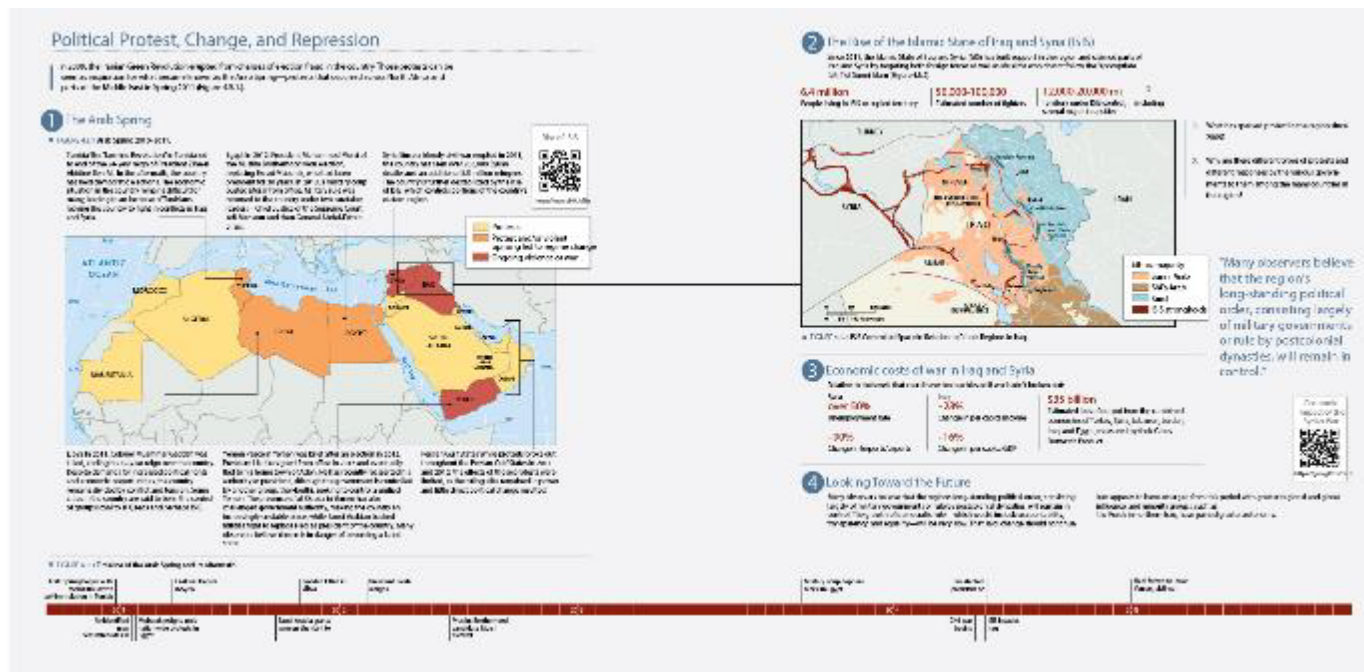
# Territory and Politics (cont.)

- U.S. war in Iraq
  - Saddam Hussein
  - **weapons of mass destruction (WMD)**
  - **jihadists**
- Nuclear tensions
- Rise of ISIS
- Regional alliances
  - **Arab League**
  - **Gulf Cooperation Council**



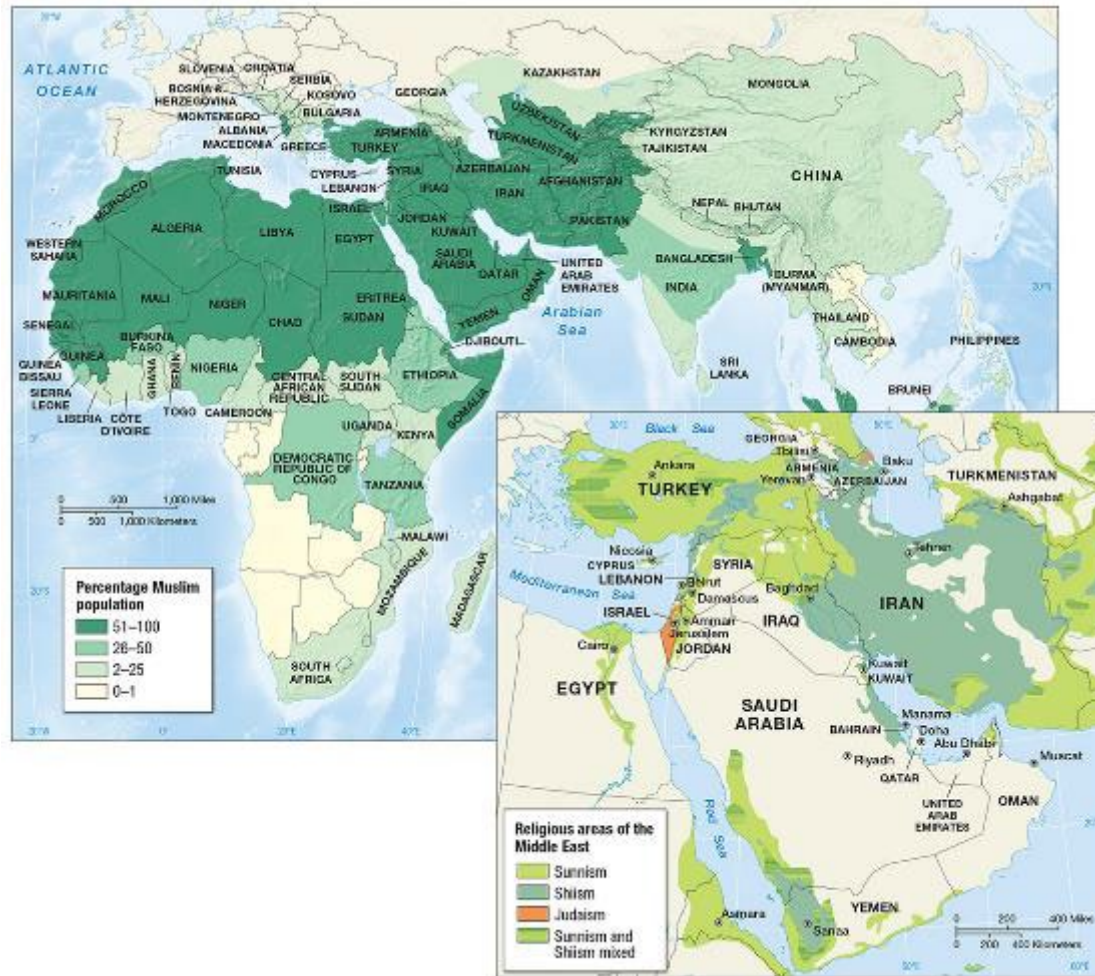
# Political Protest, Change, and Repression

- Arab Spring
  - Syria
  - role of social media
  - democratic and economic reform
  - rise of ISIS



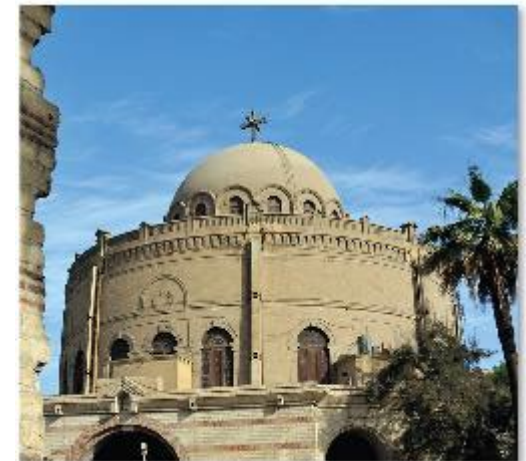
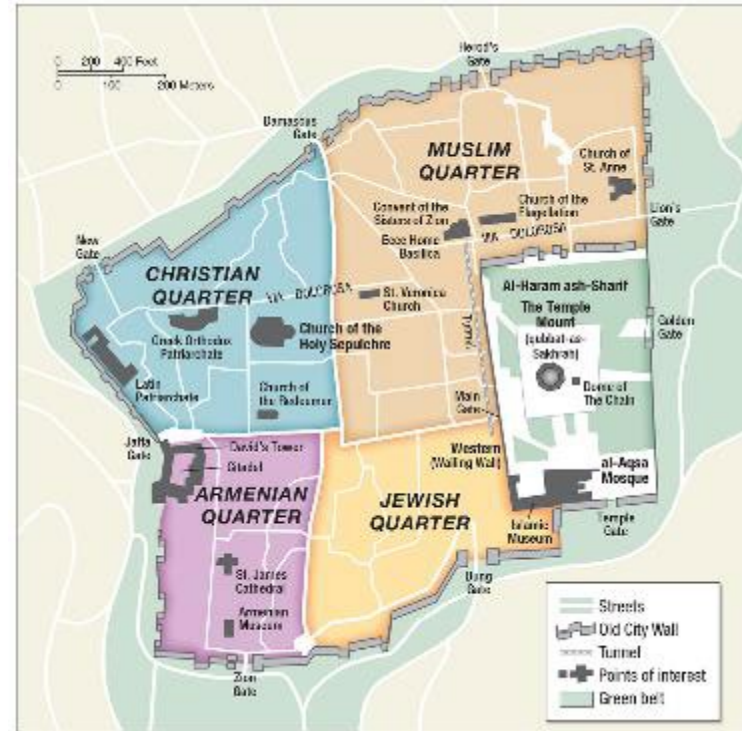
# Culture and Populations

- Culturally and demographically diverse region
  - **secularism**



# Religion and Language

- Religion
  - Islam
    - Qur'an
    - Islamism
    - Jihad
  - Christianity
  - Judaism



## Religion and Language (cont.)

- Three major language families
  - Semitic
  - Indo-European
  - Turkic

# Cultural Practices, Social Differences, and Identity

- Cultural practice
  - food
    - *meze* dishes
  - the arts



# Cultural Practices, Social Differences, and Identity (cont.)

- **Kinship**
  - tribe
  - transhumance
- **Gender**
  - stereotypes
  - *chador*
  - national politics
  - sexuality



Burqa



Niqab



Chador



al-amira



head scarf

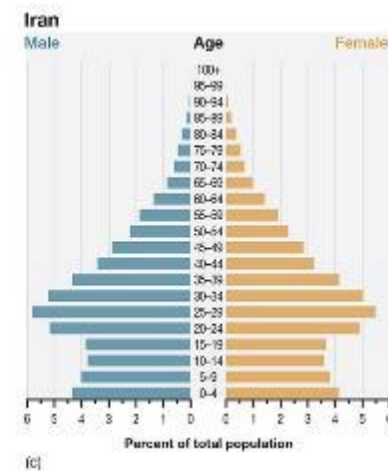
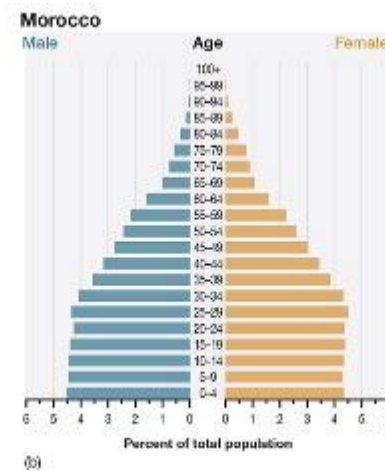
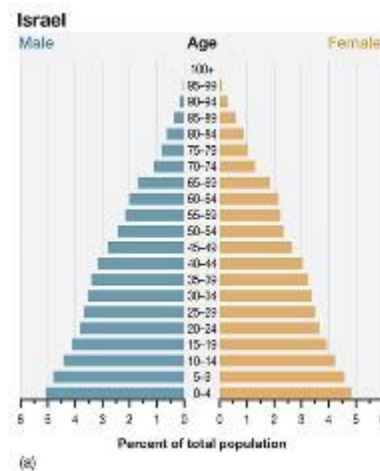
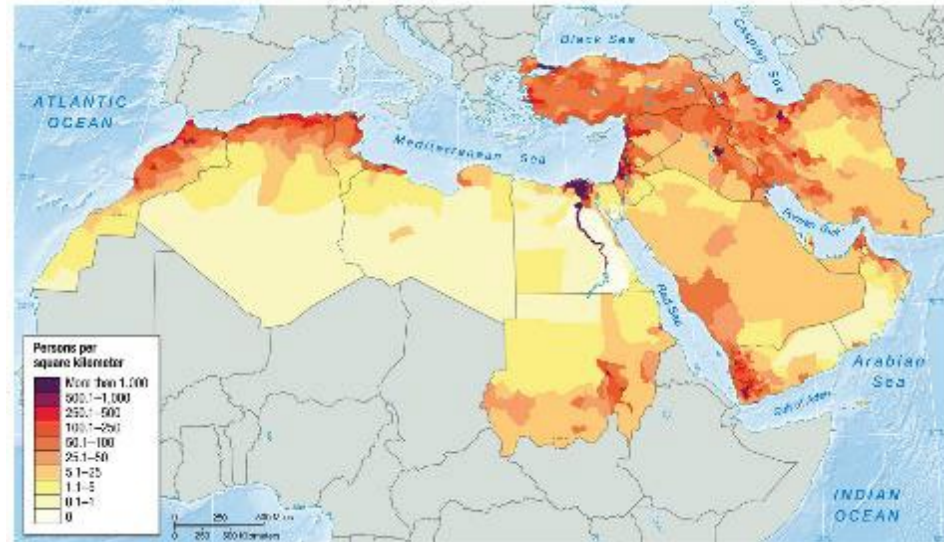


no head covering

|              | Burqa | Niqab | Chador | al-amira | head scarf | no head covering |
|--------------|-------|-------|--------|----------|------------|------------------|
|              | %     | %     | %      | %        | %          | %                |
| Tunisia      | 1     | 2     | 3      | 57       | 23         | 15               |
| Egypt        | 1     | 9     | 20     | 52       | 13         | 4                |
| Turkey       | 0     | 2     | 2      | 46       | 17         | 32               |
| Iraq         | 4     | 8     | 32     | 44       | 10         | 3                |
| Lebanon      | 2     | 1     | 3      | 32       | 12         | 49               |
| Pakistan     | 3     | 32    | 31     | 24       | 8          | 2                |
| Saudi Arabia | 11    | 63    | 8      | 10       | 5          | 3                |
| Median       | 2     | 8     | 8      | 44       | 12         | 4                |

# Demography and Urbanization

- Pull factors
  - **guest workers**
  - immigration policies
- Push factors
  - civil unrest
  - lack of economic opportunities
- Cities
  - rapid growth
  - housing and service needs not met



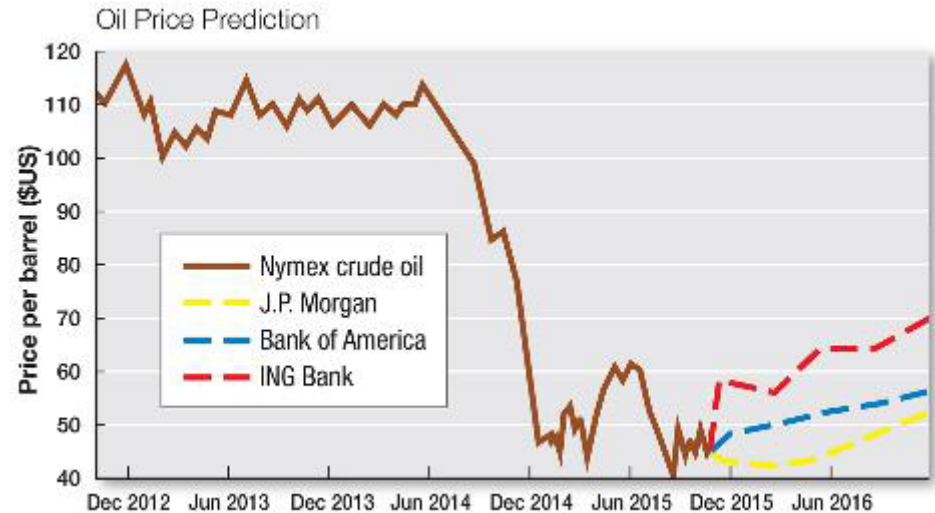
# Faces of the Region

- Syrian War refugee crisis
  - 1.6 million children displaced by the war
  - many have fled into neighboring Turkey



# Future Geographies

- Oil
  - diminishing supplies
- Water
  - sustainability
- Peace and stability



# End of Chapter 4